

Marked Report: "Which Vehicle Should I Pick?"

Own editing marks visible on the original

20

/ 25

Your best-controlled piece yet — a genuinely clever structural device, closer to full marks on a fair re-read

The car-breaks-down-so-it's-boat-or-plane dilemma is tightly told, and splitting the piece with a magazine-style subheading ("My biggest fear.") is a proper technique, not a gimmick — it's not something most students your age would think to try. On a closer read, two phrases first flagged as slips — "the plane would go" and "the pearl plane" — actually hold up fine in context, so this mark comes out higher than first assessed. What's still holding it back from a 20+ is a couple of real fixable slips, plus an ending that trails off on "..." instead of landing properly.

One real slip worth flagging — "seat **handrest**" — is the same pattern noted in your last report: a word that sounds close enough while you're writing fast, but isn't the correct form (the real word is "armrest"). Reading back out loud is still the fastest way to catch this kind of thing. Everything else flagged on a first pass — including "the plane would go" and "the pearl plane" — read fine on a fair re-read, so no need to second-guess those choices.

MARK BREAKDOWN

Content & Ideas

6 / 7

A clear, well-paced dilemma-to-resolution arc (car sabotaged → boat-or-plane choice → airport → turbulence → safe landing). Loses a mark only because it ends on "..." right after landing rather than a proper closing thought.

Structure & Organisation

5 / 6

The "My biggest fear." subheading and the colon-marked time-jump ("Half an hour later:") are genuinely advanced devices, used with confidence. Just needs a final beat after landing to round the structure off.

Style: Vocabulary & Variety

5 / 6

"Hands shook like I was holding glass," "legs were jelly," "fear crept up my spine" — a strong triplet of similes, and "the pearl plane" is a nice final descriptive touch to end on. Only "seat handrest" needed fixing.

Technical Accuracy

4 / 6

A couple of small fixable slips remain (missing dialogue punctuation, "of a car" instead of "of my car," "seat handrest"). Genuinely good evidence of self-correction while writing — several errors were already caught and crossed out on the original page.

ANNOTATED EXTRACT

Marked against a four-strand creative-writing rubric (Content & Ideas / Structure / Style / Technical Accuracy) scaled to 25 · Summit Tuition

Which vehicle should I pick?

I had been thinking about none of this one hour ago. I was supposed to be driving to France by car (because there were no trains available); however, when I got to start my car I realised I had been robbed of some of the most important components of a car¹. So now I had two options: go on a boat or an aeroplane. I was terrified of both of them.

In the end, I chose to be on an aeroplane as I had a feeling I would vomit on a boat. "Hi could I get a taxi to the airport. Really, thanks!"² I called while waiting on the large, dusty, grey pavement.

Half an hour later: I was at the airport, post security and waiting for my flight. During the wait, my hands shook like I was holding glass, my legs were jelly and fear crept up my spine. Finally after the wait I was on the plane.

My biggest fear.

For every jolt on it³ after takeoff, I was worried that the plane would go plummeting straight towards the ground. I held on to the seat handrest⁴ until my knuckles were snow white. Whoosh! the plane would go every once in a while, making my heart skip a beat.

Eventually I arrived in one piece and was the first to leave the pearl plane...

NUMBERED CORRECTIONS

#	TYPE	ISSUE	FIX
1	Reference	You've already told us it's <i>your</i> car — calling it "a car" the second time reads like a different, random car.	"robbed of some of the most important components of my car"
2	Punctuation	A spoken request needs a comma after the greeting and a question mark, not a full stop.	"Hi, could I get a taxi to the airport, please? Thanks so much!"
3	Clarity	"on it" is vague this far from "plane" — cutting it is cleaner than patching it.	"For every jolt after takeoff"
4	Wrong word	The part of a seat you grip isn't called a "handrest" — that word doesn't exist in English.	"I held on to the armrest"

STRENGTHS

A real structural idea, not just a story

- Splitting the piece with a bold subheading ("*My biggest fear.*") is a magazine/article device — it signals a shift in focus without needing a clumsy linking sentence.
- "Half an hour later:" uses a colon to jump time cleanly, echoing the confident one-word-sentence trick from your last piece.
- Three well-chosen descriptors again — "*large, dusty, grey pavement*" — you're clearly using this technique on purpose now, not by accident.
- Ending on "*the pearl plane*" is a nice, deliberate final image rather than a plain "the plane" — worth doing on purpose again.

Editing as you go

- Multiple live corrections visible on your own page (fixing verb tense, swapping in "however," catching "unavailable" and rewording it) — this is exactly the habit that will eventually catch things like the "handrest" slip too.
- A tight triplet of similes for fear — "*hands shook like I was holding glass,*" "*legs were jelly,*" "*fear crept up my spine*" — shows real control of tone, not just description for its own sake.
- The turbulence section builds real physical tension (white knuckles, the jolt, the "Whoosh!") — a reader can feel it.

NEXT STEPS

This is the same honest note as last time, because it's still the main thing between you and a 20+: (1) read the finished piece back out loud once, slowly — "seat handrest" sounds almost right when you're writing at speed, which is exactly why a live read-back catches it and a quick glance doesn't; (2) check any word you've referred to earlier in the piece stays consistent the second time ("my car," not "a car"); and (3) budget the last two minutes for a proper ending sentence instead of trailing off on "..." — you'd already survived the flight here, so one closing line (how it felt to be back on solid ground) would have finished the piece rather than just stopping it.